SubAlert design system

STEP A

Styling approach

MY CHOICE

CSS Modules + :root custom properties

All tokens live once in `src/styles/tokens.css` as `--color-*`, `--font-size-*` and `--space-*`. Each component has its own `Button.module.css` that only reads tokens, never raw hex values.

Why not the others

Tailwind and UI libraries are faster later but add setup and a second thing to learn on top of React Router and Supabase. CSS Modules is what we used in the styling unit, and plain variables make a dark theme possible later by changing one block.

STEP B

Colour tokens

Five colours. Teal means "you're in control" (buttons, selected states). Orange-red is saved for one job: trials about to charge you. Everything else is neutral so the urgent colour stands out.

Aa

`--color-primary`
#0E6E5C
Buttons, links, selected toggle, active filter, focus ring

Aa

`--color-accent`
#C2410C
Urgent trials only: stripe, badge, "Tomorrow", errors

Aa

`--color-bg`
#F5F7F8
Page background behind cards and forms

Aa

`--color-surface`
#FFFFFF
Cards, rows, header, inputs, auth card

Aa

`--color-text`
#1A1D21
Body text, headings, prices

`--color-text-muted`
#5A6470 grey for labels, captions, footer

`--color-border`
#8A949E input and button outlines

`--color-divider`
#E3E7EA card edges, row lines

The three greys are neutral helpers, not extra brand colours.

Text on background	Example	Contrast	WCAG AA (4.5 : 1)
Text on page background	Active trials	15.7 : 1	PASS
Muted text on surface	Trial end date	6.0 : 1	PASS
White on primary (button, selected)	Save	6.2 : 1	PASS
Primary on page background (links)	Register	5.7 : 1	PASS
Accent on surface (urgent date, errors)	Tomorrow	5.2 : 1	PASS
White on accent (urgent badge)	Urgent	5.2 : 1	PASS
Border on surface (input outline, non-text)		3.1 : 1	PASS (3 : 1 for UI parts)

STEP C

Type scale

One font, Inter (Google Fonts), falling back to the system sans-serif. Three sizes, shown at real size.

Heading `--font-size-lg` 24px / 700 Bold / line 1.25	**Add subscription**	Screen titles, auth card titles, summary card numbers ("2", "$38/mo")
Body `--font-size-md` 16px / 400 Regular / line 1.5 600 for service names	Streaming+ ends tomorrow. Decide before you're charged $15.99.	Service names, prices, input text, button labels (14px bold is the one exception, to fit phone headers)
Small `--font-size-sm` 13px / 400 Regular / line 1.4	Trial end date · Your data is synced to your account	Form labels, badges, filter pills, error messages, footer

Spacing and components

Base unit: 8px
Corner radius: 8px (pills fully round)

STEP D

Spacing rule: everything is a multiple of 8px

`--space-1`	**8px**		Tight: label to input, icon to text, between pills
`--space-2`	**16px**		Inside cards and rows, between form fields, phone screen edge
`--space-3`	**24px**		Between cards in a grid, auth card padding
`--space-4`	**32px**		Between page sections, desktop screen edge



Summary cards, desktop: 32 edge · 24 gap · 16 inside

Screen edge padding

Phone: **16px** (`--space-2`)

Desktop: **32px** (`--space-4`), content max width 1120px

Touch targets

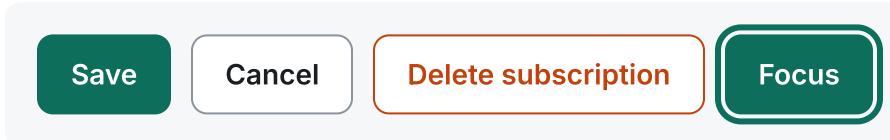
Buttons, inputs and toggles are at least **40px** tall (5 × 8) so they're easy to tap.

STEP E

Reusable components (used on more than one screen)

Button

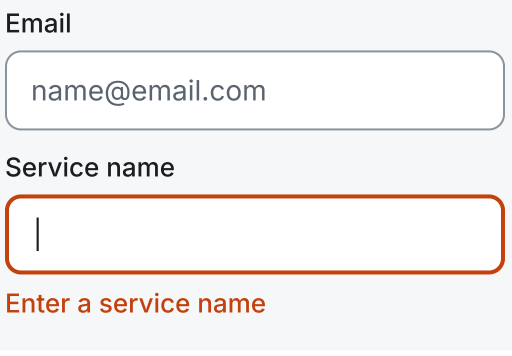
atom · every screen



Props: `variant` ("primary" | "secondary" | "danger"), `type`, `onClick`, `children`. One primary button per screen.

FormField

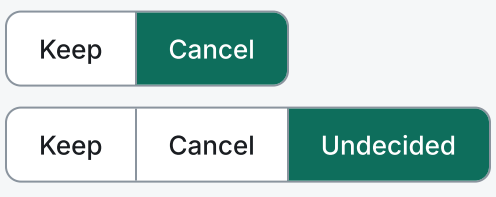
molecule · Add, Edit, Log in, Register



Props: `label`, `id`, `type`, `value`, `onChange`, `error`, `placeholder`. Label is linked with `htmlFor`.

DecisionToggle

molecule · Dashboard, Add, Edit



Props: `value`, `onChange`, `options` (2 on list rows, 3 on the form). Built from real `<button>`s with `aria-pressed`.

Badge + Avatar

atoms · Dashboard, header



Badge: `level` ("urgent" ≤ 48h, "soon" ≤ 7 days, "later"), `children`. **Avatar:** `name`, `variant`. Pills reuse the same shape.

Components and responsive plan

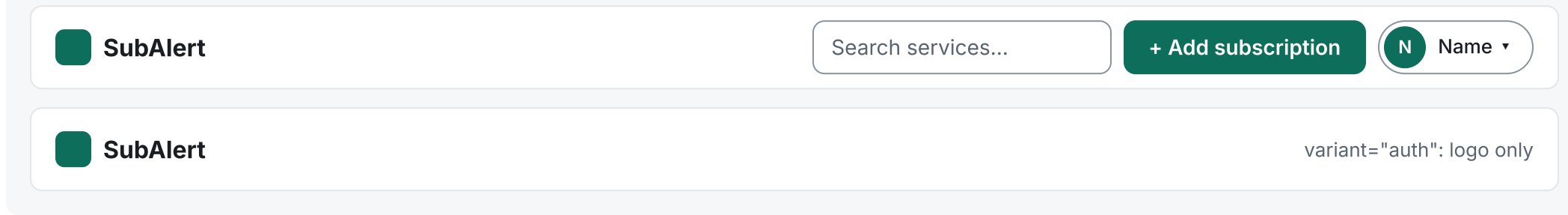
Breakpoint: 640px
Tested down to 375px wide

STEP E (CONTINUED)

Reusable components

Header + UserMenu

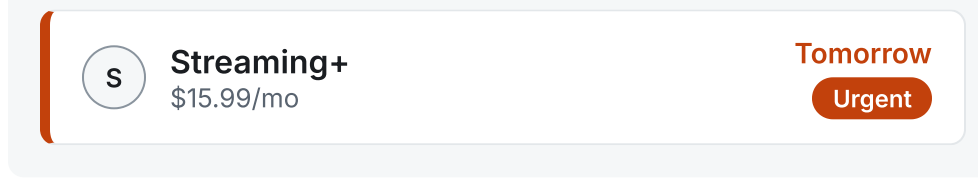
organism + molecule · Dashboard, Add, Edit (Log in and Register use the logo-only variant)



Header props: `variant` ("app" | "auth"), `searchQuery`, `onSearch`. **UserMenu props:** `user`, `onLogout`. Uses `<header>` and `<nav>`.

SubscriptionRow

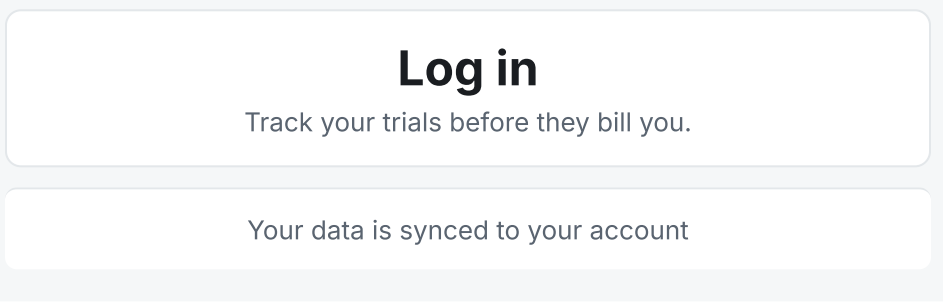
molecule · repeated on Dashboard



Props: `subscription`, `onDecisionChange`, `onEdit`, `onDelete`. Rendered in a list with `key={sub.id}`.

Footer + AuthCard

organisms · all desktop screens / Log in, Register

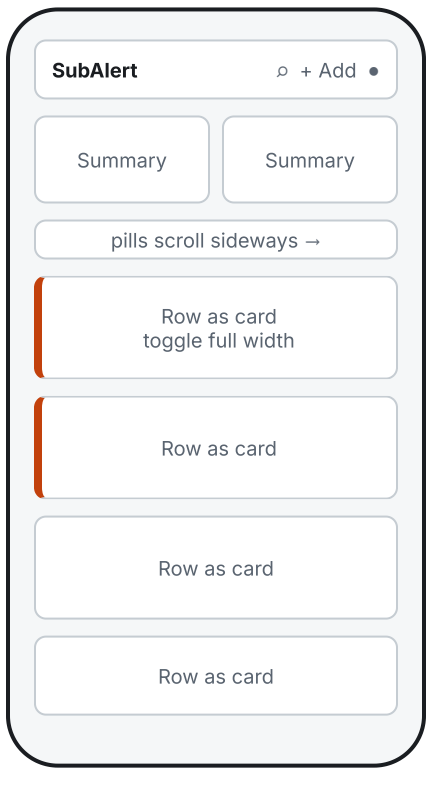


AuthCard props: `title`, `subtitle`, `children` (the form). **Footer:** no props.

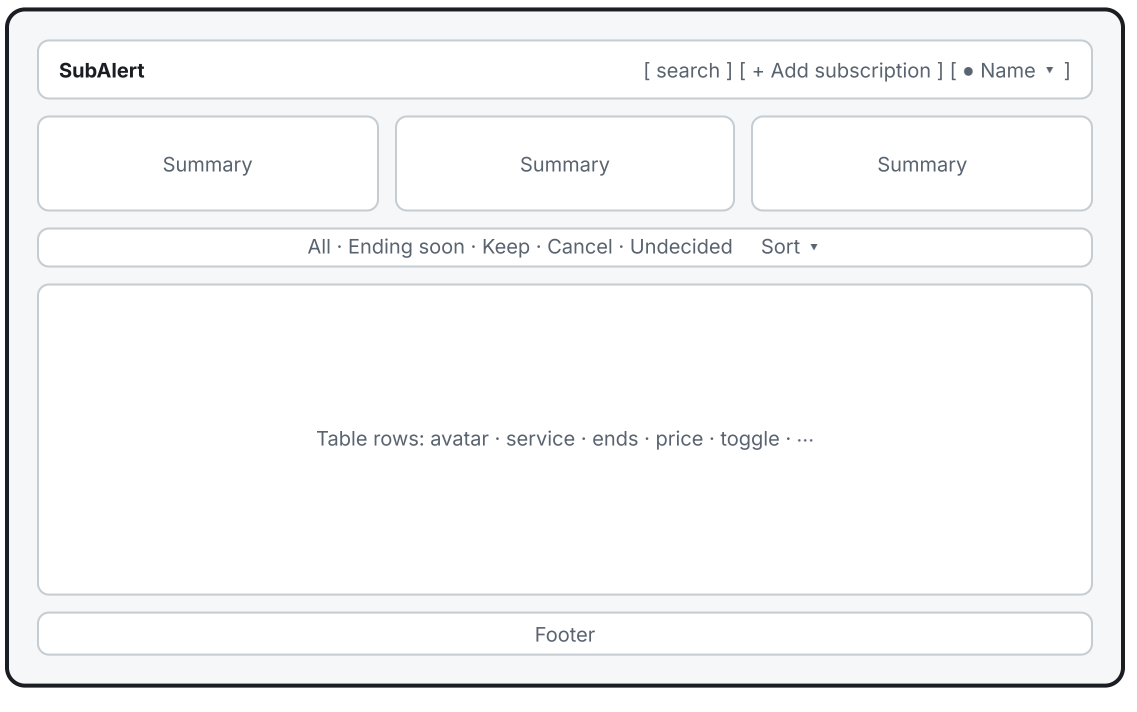
STEP F

Responsive plan

Below 640px (phone)



640px and up (desktop)



Part	Below 640px (phone)	640px and up (desktop)
Summary cards	2 across (third card hidden)	3 across with CSS Grid
Subscription list	Stacked cards, toggle full width	Table-style rows
Header	Search icon, "+ Add", avatar	Search box, "+ Add subscription", UserMenu with name
Forms (Add/Edit, Log in, Register)	Full width, Save button pinned to the bottom	Centred, max width 440px; auth forms inside a card
Footer	Hidden	Shown
Screen edge padding	16px	32px, content max width 1120px

Written mobile-first: base styles are the phone layout, then `@media (min-width: 640px)` adds the desktop layout. **No horizontal scrolling at 375px**; the filter pills scroll inside their own row, not the page.

Accessibility and tokens

Checked before building
Copy of the tokens file

BEFORE I BUILD

Accessibility check

- ✓ **Contrast:** every text pair passes 4.5 : 1 (lowest is 5.2 : 1, see page 1).
- ✓ **Semantic elements:** `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<footer>`, `<form>`, and real `<button>`s for toggles, pills and menus.
- ✓ **Images:** the app has no photos. The logo gets `alt="SubAlert"`; avatars and icons are decorative (`alt=""` or `aria-hidden`).
- ✓ **Labels:** `FormField` always renders a `<label htmlFor>` matching the input's `id`. Errors are linked with `aria-describedby`.
- ✓ **Keyboard:** every button and link is reachable with Tab and shows a 3px teal focus ring (`:focus-visible`).
- ✓ **Not colour alone:** urgency is shown with colour *and* text ("Urgent", "Tomorrow") and a thicker stripe.

WHAT I KEEP

src/styles/tokens.css

```
/* Colour */
:root {
  --color-primary: #0E6E5C;
  --color-accent: #C2410C;
  --color-bg: #F5F7F8;
  --color-surface: #FFFFFF;
  --color-text: #1A1D21;
  /* neutral helpers */
  --color-text-muted: #5A6470;
  --color-border: #8A949E;
  --color-divider: #E3E7EA;

  /* Type (Inter) */
  --font-family: "Inter", system-ui, sans-serif;
  --font-size-lg: 24px;  /* heading */
  --font-size-md: 16px;  /* body    */
  --font-size-sm: 13px;  /* small   */

  /* Spacing: base 8px */
  --space-1: 8px;
  --space-2: 16px;
  --space-3: 24px;
  --space-4: 32px;
  --radius: 8px;
}

/* Breakpoint */
@media (min-width: 640px) { ... }
```

STEP E SUMMARY

Component list (becomes src/components/)

Component	Level	Appears on	Props it takes
Button	atom	Every screen	`variant, type, onClick, children`
FormField	molecule	Add, Edit, Log in, Register	`label, id, type, value, onChange, error, placeholder`
DecisionToggle	molecule	Dashboard, Add, Edit	`value, onChange, options`
Badge	atom	Dashboard (every row, repeated)	`level, children`
Avatar	atom	Dashboard (rows), header on Dashboard, Add, Edit	`name, variant`
UserMenu	molecule	Dashboard, Add, Edit	`user, onLogout`
SubscriptionRow	molecule	Dashboard (repeated per subscription)	`subscription, onDecisionChange, onEdit, onDelete`
Header	organism	Every screen ("app" or "auth" variant)	`variant, searchQuery, onSearch`
AuthCard	organism	Log in, Register	`title, subtitle, children`
Footer	organism	Every screen on desktop	`none`

No UI library, so every component is built by me with CSS Modules. Atoms only use tokens; molecules only use atoms; organisms use both.